

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5
 ♥ A Q 8 5
 ♦ 5 4 3
 ♣ Q J 10 2

♠ A Q 10 6

♥ 7

♦ K J 9 6 2

♣ K 6 5



♠ 9 4 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A Q 10 8

♣ 9 8 3

♠ K J 7 2

♥ K J 10 3 2

♦ 7

♣ A 7 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♠ 3

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠

Lead any ♠.

You have ♦ winners, but dummy will surely be short since he has at least 8 cards in the Major suits.

Partner has whatever ♥ strength your side possesses.

It is very likely that declarer will want to do some cross-trumping. To try to cut that down your best lead is a trump.

Just imagine that declarer wins the first ♠ in his hand and plays a ♥ to dummy's honors. West will win and play another trump. Whenever you win your first ♦ you will play your last trump.

As you can imagine, declarer will be in a whole lot of trouble.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 7 2
 ♥ K 8 7
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ A 8 5 4

♠ 10 5

♥ J 10 4 2

♦ 9 6 5 4 3

♣ J 9



♠ A Q 6

♥ A Q 9

♦ A 10 7

♣ K Q 7 3

♠ K J 9 4 3

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 8 2

♣ 10 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by East

Lead: ♥6

low ♠ you would have handed him his 12 trick on a platter.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♥6.

You held this identical hand in Deal 3. The declarer was playing 3NT and the best lead was the ♠4, fourth down.

It's different when the contract is 6NT. Against 6NT you should make a passive lead, which means don't underlead any honors. Against 6NT you have little chance of establishing a suit to win four or five tricks. Instead, you just want to try to not give declarer an undeserved trick.

So any passive lead would be OK, you pick the ♥ just because they are less likely to have an unbid 4-card Major in either hand.

Declarer has 11 winners sitting there; if you had led a

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 5 4

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ K 6 2

♣ 10 2

♠ A 2

♥ A 9 7

♦ 10 5 3

♣ A K Q 7 6



♠ Q 9 7 6 3

♥ 10 4 3

♦ 4

♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ J 10

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q J 9 8 7

♣ J 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	3 ♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♦
Pass	6 ♦		
All Pass			

6 ♦ by South

Lead: ♠ 4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6 ♦

Lead the ♠ 4.

Against a notrump slam it is best to make a passive lead so you don't give declarer an undeserved winner.

Against a suit slam the situation is very different. Against strong dummy bidding like this you are pretty sure that if you don't establish a winner early declarer will find something in dummy to discard losers on. In this hand it is dummy's ♣ suit.

Your most promising suit is ♠s. Obviously partner has a very weak hand, but if he has the ♠Q you can set up your ♠K before your King of trumps is dislodged.

Without a ♠ lead declarer will have smooth sailing.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 4 3
 ♥ A 9 8
 ♦ A J 10 6
 ♣ Q 10 4

♠ Q J 10 8
 ♥ Q 10 5 4 2
 ♦ 7 3
 ♣ A 3



♠ 9 7 5
 ♥ J 7
 ♦ K Q 8
 ♣ K J 9 8 2

♠ K 6 2
 ♥ K 6 3
 ♦ 9 5 4 2
 ♣ 7 6 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♥4			

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥4.

This is a close call. The top of your ♠ honor sequence is very tempting, but even when you find partner with the ♠K you can still only establish three ♠ winners to go with your ♣A. Unfortunately, that's not enough to defeat the contract.

Leading a ♥ from your 5-card suit is riskier, but it has the potential of setting up an additional winner. In this hand, as you see, the ♥ lead gets you 4 ♥ winners to go with your ♣A.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 10 6 2

♥ 10

♦ Q J 9 6

♣ Q 10 9 3

♠ A 9 3

♥ Q J 7 4 3

♦ K

♣ K 8 7 4



♠ 8 4

♥ 9 8 2

♦ A 10 5 3

♣ A J 6 2

♠ K J 7 5

♥ A K 6 5

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ 5

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♣

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♥9

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♥

Underleading an Ace against a suit contract is the absolute worst opening lead in Bridge. A careful look at this hand shows just how bad it can turn out.

And leading from a doubleton in a suit the opponents have bid is almost as bad.

So by process of elimination you lead a trump, probably the ♥9.

And when North plays ♣s, (preparing to ruff in dummy), you will win and play another trump. Even if North guesses the ♠s correctly he will not be able to make the contract.